

Seminar on Context-Sensitivity
Hilary 2009
Readings for Weeks 3 and 4 (on attitude reports)

The entry on 'Propositional Attitude Reports' in the Stanford encyclopedia provides a reasonable overview of the literature on the topic and an exhaustive bibliography. The following is a selection of readings developing and criticising specifically contextualist approaches.

Ernest Sosa. 'Propositional Attitudes De Dicto and De Re'. *Journal of Philosophy* 67 (1970), pp. 883–896 (an early argument for contextualism, though at the end he suddenly goes pragmatic).

Stephen Schiffer. 'Naming and Knowing'. In: *Midwest Studies in Philosophy II: Contemporary Perspectives in the Philosophy of Language*. Ed. by Peter French, Theodore E. Uehling Jr., and Howard K. Wettstein. Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1979, pp. 28–41 (advocates the "hidden indexical" theory).

Stephen Schiffer. 'Belief Ascription'. *Journal of Philosophy* 89 (1992), pp. 499–521 (criticises the account in 'Naming and Knowing' on the grounds that belief is not a three-place relation).

Peter Ludlow. 'Logical Form and the Hidden Indexical Theory: A Reply to Schiffer'. *Journal of Philosophy* 92 (1995), pp. 102–107 (defends the hidden indexical theory, on a straightforwardly syntactic interpretation).

Mark Crimmins and John Perry. 'The Prince and the Phone Booth: Reporting Puzzling Beliefs'. *Journal of Philosophy* 86 (1989), pp. 685–711 (an influential account on which the contextual variability of attitude reports comes from "unarticulated constituents").

Kent Bach. 'Do Belief Reports Report Beliefs?' *Pacific Philosophical Quarterly* 78 (1997), pp. 215–241.

Scott Soames. 'Naming and Asserting'. In: *Semantics versus Pragmatics*. Ed. by Zoltán Gendler Szabó. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2005, ? (recants Soames's earlier adherence to "naïve Russellianism" in favour of a contextualist view according to which attitude reports express "propositional matrices" whose completions involve straightforwardly descriptive material).

Mark Richard. *Propositional Attitudes: An Essay on Thoughts and How we Ascribe them*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1990 (an intricate contextualist view that assigns partly linguistic semantic values to everything).

Mark Crimmins. *Talk About Beliefs*. Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press, 1992 (develops the view set forth in Crimmins and Perry).

Mark Crimmins. 'Context in the attitudes'. *Linguistics and Philosophy* 15 (1992), pp. 185–198 (Crimmins' contribution to a debate with Richard).

Mark Richard. 'Attitudes in Context'. *Linguistics and Philosophy* 16 (1993), pp. 126–148 (Richard's contribution to a debate with Crimmins).

François Recanati. *Direct Reference: From Language to Thought*. Oxford: Blackwell, 1993 (See especially chapters 17–20, which develop a broadly Fregean form of contextualism on which "that" clauses in attitude reports stand, in context, for entities with built in "modes of presentation").

François Recanati. *Oratio Obliqua, Oratio Recta*. Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press, 2000 (I haven't had a chance to read this yet, but Recanati informs me that it advocates a "Russellian" form of contextualism on which the action is in the attitude verb rather than the "that" clause).